



American Board
of Internal Medicine®

Patient and Public Engagement at ABIM

Lois Margaret Nora Endowed Lecture
September 17, 2026

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Chief Medical Officer, ABIM

Disclosures

None

No exam questions will be disclosed in my presentation



CELEBRATING 90 YEARS

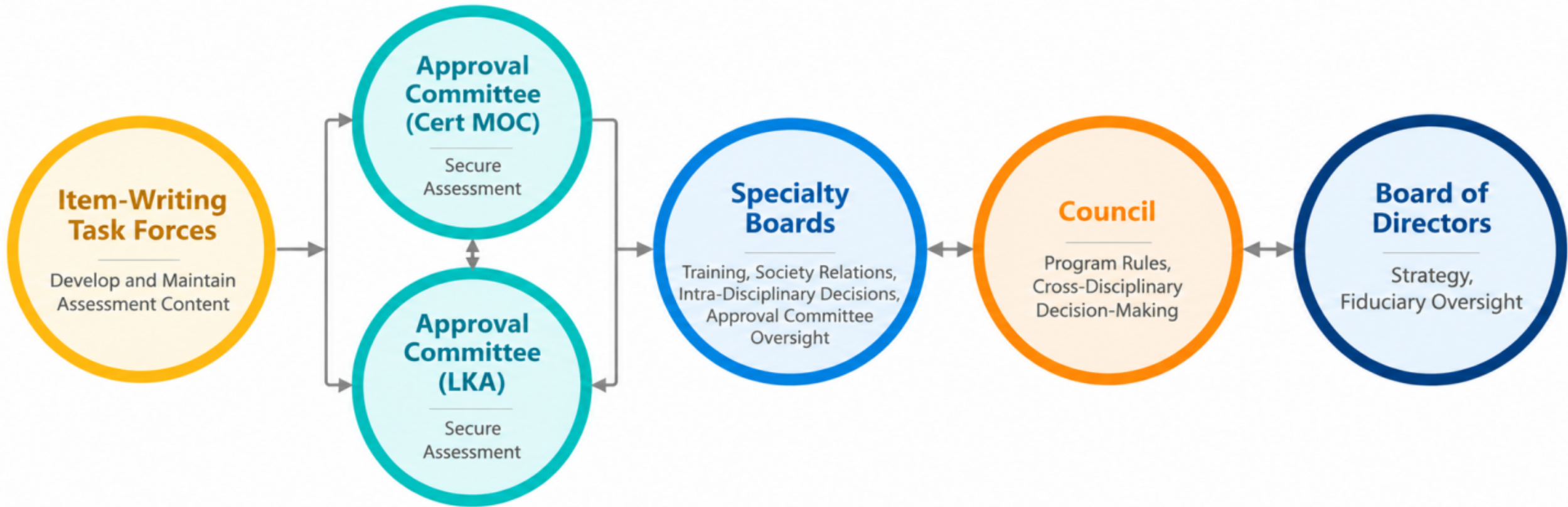
American Board
of Internal Medicine®

Of the Profession, **For the Public®**

How Did We Start?



ABIM Governance Structure

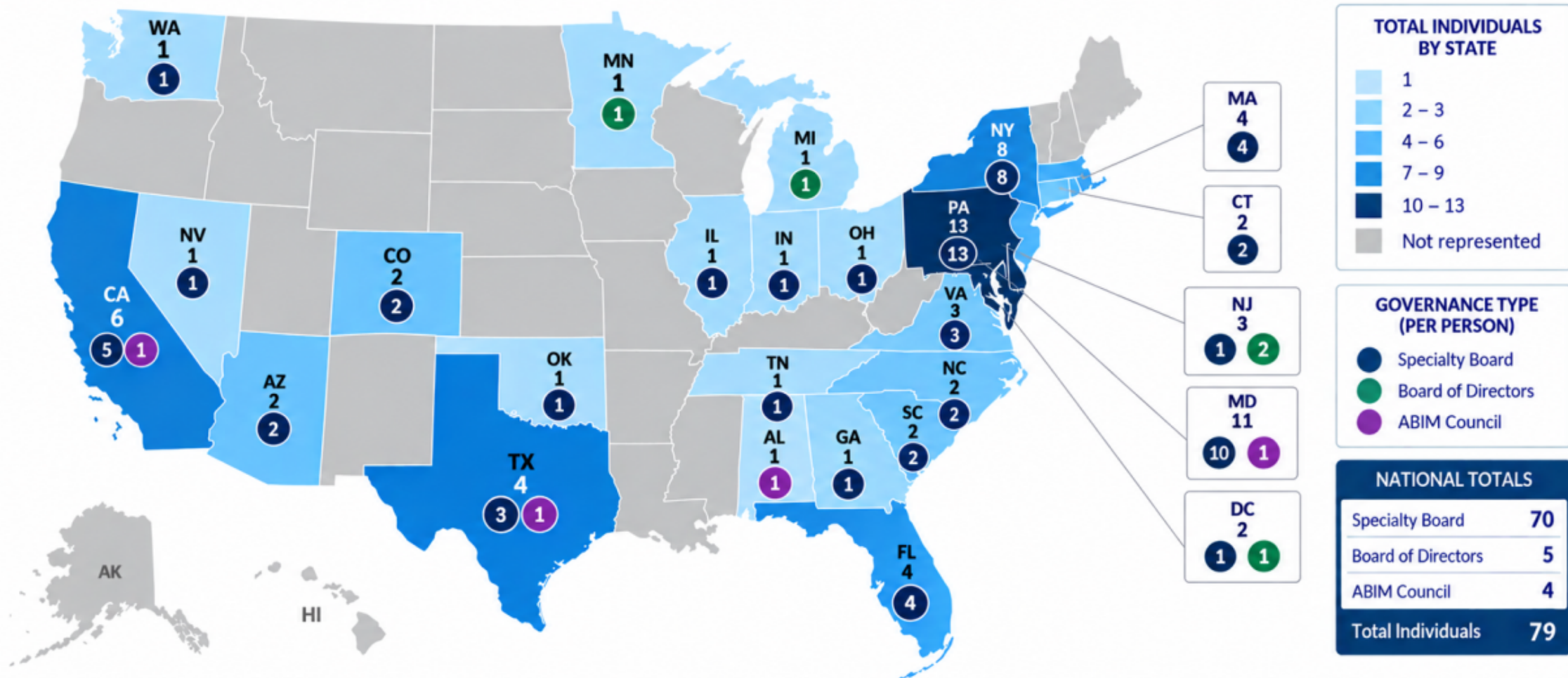


Where Are We Now?



ABIM Patient / Public / Interprofessional Governance Members

2013 – 2026 | Total Individuals = 79 | 26 States Represented



Specialty Boards: Discipline-Specific Governance

Assessments

Training

**Medical
Knowledge and
Practice
Assessment**

**Diplomate and
Society Relations**

Public Experts in ABIM Governance

Inter-professional colleagues – members of **care team**, experience with other certification models

Patient – **lived experience** with a particular condition as a patient or caregiver

National perspective on trends inside the discipline or across healthcare

Advisory role on policies & communications

Leverage networks of consumers / providers on value of Board Certification

What ABIM Physicians say about Public Members

"Our public members have been invaluable colleagues and partners in achieving the ABIM mission."



Furman S. McDonald, MD, MPH, Senior Vice
President for Academic and Medical Affairs

"Meg Koepke can identify things we might overlook and be a positive catalyst for change while keeping our focus on the patient."



Rajeev Jain, MD, FACP, FASGE, AGAF,
Former Chair of the Board of Directors

What Public Members Say About Their Role

"I decided to apply to this position because my desire is to make sure the patient voice is always there as part of the conversation."

"Experiencing both excellent and inadequate care taught me that certification standards truly matter."



Desirée A. H. Walker
Patient Advocate, Health Education |
Health Equity Activist



Colleen Connor
Pulmonary Hypertension
Association | *Board Trustee*

Shared Decision Making

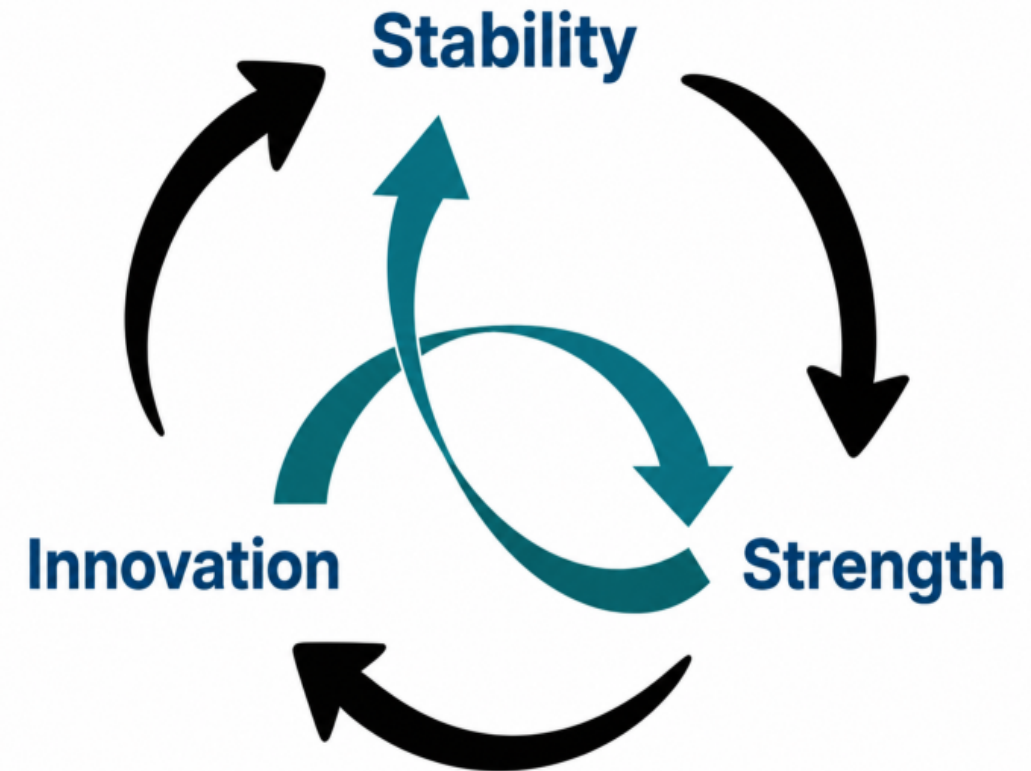


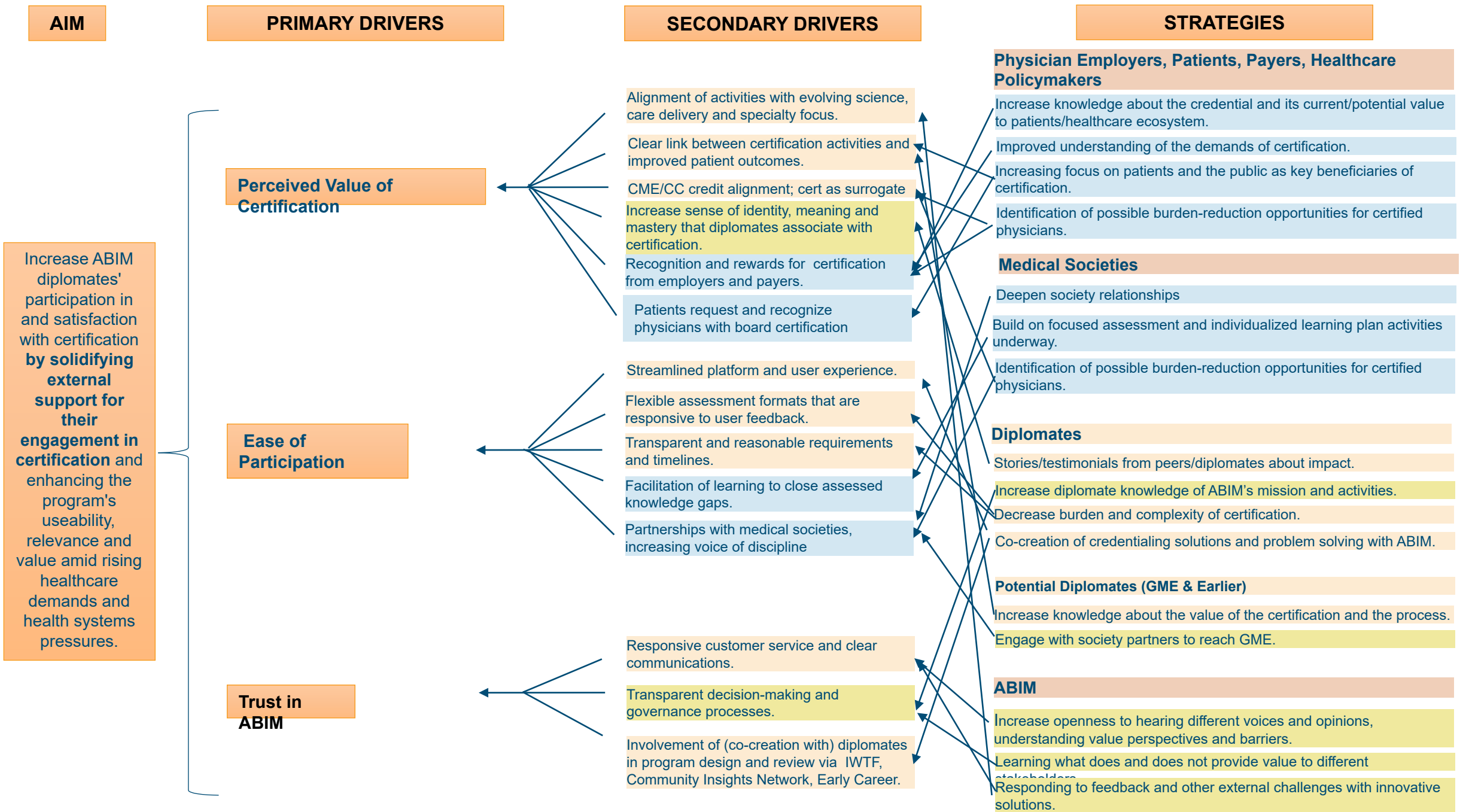
Lessons Learned

- Naming
- Hard to recruit
- Requires (ongoing) intention to engage
- Need (repeated) affirmation of importance of their vote/voice
- Orientation needed! Avoid acronyms
- Resources needed for engagement

Dr. Furman McDonald's Vision for ABIM

- **STABILIZE** the Program
- **STRENGTHEN** the Credential
 - Expand the Circle of Stakeholders
 - Early Career Diplomates
 - Mid-Career Diplomates
 - Societies
 - Patients/Public
 - The Greater Health Care System
- **Advance INNOVATION**





What Now?



Deeper Engagement With Patient &
Public Members of ABIM Governance



Forge Connections with Patient-
Facing Organizations

New Deputy CMO: Dr. Yuvaram Reddy

- Nephrologist and researcher
 - Expertise in community engaged research and implementation science
 - Previously worked with patients on program co-design, advocacy, op-eds



Can kidney dialysis be done at home? We can make treatment more accessible, so why aren't we?

We are a nephrologist and a patient now living with a kidney transplant, working together to try to improve access to home dialysis.

Amber Pettis and Dr. Yuvaram Reddy Opinion contributors

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ABIM PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT INITIATIVE

Exploration of Public Member Perspectives
Summary of Findings, **September 2024**

Debra L. Ness



Debra Ness,
Former
President of
The NPWF
*(National Partnership for
Women and Families)*

Deeper Engagement: Public Members in ABIM Governance

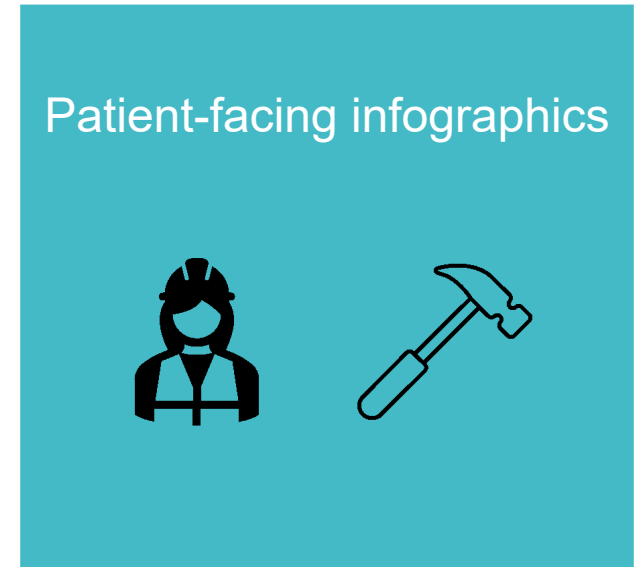
- Focused interviews of current/recent members
 - Focus on strengthening relationships
- CRM with connects to patient-facing organizations
- Alida
 - Possible platform for public member internal engagement
- Co-creation of patient-facing materials
- Support activities with/for external audiences

Identifying Patient-Facing Organizations



Co-creating materials

Leveraging patient experiences to co-create patient-facing materials



Thank You



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Questions to Share with Moderator

- What suggestions do you have for organizations that are much earlier on in their patient/public engagement work?
 - Find quick wins. Think about workflows where the patient or public voice could be integrated, and where these voices could help shape progress (thinking about grantmaking programs, knowledge gap assessments and how knowledge gaps affect patient care)
- Are there opportunities to learn from ABMS' patient engagement work?
 - PFAC. Can PFAC serve as consultants or advisors to Boards?
- What are lessons learned from ABIM's earlier engagement work
 - Sustainability matters. Must be intentional about having dedicated effort and objectives for patient engagement work.